My Spelling Words: /är/, /âr/ & /îr/

Name: _____ Date: _____

/är/ like car & star: spelled ar (spark, sharp, alarm).
/âr/ like care & hair: spelled are (scare) or air (repair, hairy).
/îr/ like ear & deer: spelled ear (tear, gear), eer (cheer), or eir (weird).
Look out for tear: this week it is a drop from your eye (/îr/), not to rip (/âr/).

/är/ — like car & star

ar spark scarf sharp alarm harsh pardon★

/âr/ — like care & hair

are prepare scare scarce spare compare square aware★

air repair hairy upstairs

/îr/ — like ear & deer

ear tear earring rear gear weary★

eer cheer career★

eir weird

Tricky words: look closely!

tear (drop from your eye (/îr/), not to rip)
scarce (scare + c; the last c says /s/)
upstairs (compound: up + stairs)
weird (rule-breaker: /îr/ is spelled eir)
earring (ear + ring: don't forget both r's)
square (squ says /skw/, then are)

Helpful hints (most of the time):

- are is usually at the end: scare, spare, square, compare
- air is usually in the middle or before y: repair, hairy, upstairs
- ear often spells /îr/: tear (a drop from your eye), rear, gear
- eer at the end can spell /îr/: cheer, career · weird is the eir rule-breaker

★ = challenge word (optional, for extra practice).

Word Sort: Which Sound?

Name: _____ Date: _____

Say each word. Which vowel sound do you hear? Write it in that box.
Then circle the letters that spell the sound (ar, are, air, ear, eer, or eir).

Word Bank

cheer	spark	scare	tear	sharp	prepare
gear	scarf	repair	weird	alarm	spare
rear	hairy	harsh	compare	earring	square
scarce	upstairs	aware	pardon	career	weary

/är/ like car & star

_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____

6 words

/âr/ like care & hair

_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____

10 words

/îr/ like ear & deer

_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____
_____ _____

8 words

Hint: tear goes with /îr/ (a drop from your eye). Challenge words are optional.

are, air, or ear? ear, eer, or eir?

Name: _____ Date: _____

Say the word. Write the missing letters. Then write the whole word.

/âr/ are or air? are at the end (scare). air in the middle or before y (repair, hairy).
/îr/ ear, eer, or eir? ear often (tear, gear). eer at the end (cheer). weird is eir.

1. ch____ (ear / eer / eir)
2. sc____ (are / air)
3. t____ (ear / eer / eir)
4. prep____ (are / air)
5. g____ (ear / eer / eir)
6. rep____ (are / air)
7. w____d (ear / eer / eir)
8. sp____ (are / air)
9. r____ (ear / eer / eir)
10. h____y (are / air)
11. comp____ (are / air)
12. ____ring (ear / eer / eir)
13. squ____ (are / air)
14. upst____s (are / air)
15. aw____ (are / air)
16. car____ (ear / eer / eir)
17. w____y (ear / eer / eir)

Fill in the Blank (1 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Pick a word from the word bank. Write it on the line. Each word is used once.

Word Bank (all 24 words)

weary	square	spark	career	scare	pardon
tear	repair	alarm	scarf	prepare	gear
aware	cheer	sharp	upstairs	spare	weird
rear	hairy	compare	earring	harsh	scarce

1. A tiny _____ jumped from the campfire.
2. We need to _____ a snack for the hike.
3. The fans began to _____ when the team scored.
4. A _____ rolled down her cheek at the end of the movie.
5. She wrapped a red _____ around her neck.
6. Loud thunder can _____ the dog.
7. Dad will _____ the broken chair this afternoon.
8. Mom found a silver _____ under the couch.
9. Shade was _____ on the hot playground.
10. The soup had a _____ green color.
11. Be careful. That knife is very _____.
12. The _____ door of the van was wide open.

Fill in the Blank (2 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Pick a word from the word bank. Write it on the line. Each word is used once.

Word Bank (all 24 words)

weary	square	spark	career	scare	pardon
tear	repair	alarm	scarf	prepare	gear
aware	cheer	sharp	upstairs	spare	weird
rear	hairy	compare	earring	harsh	scarce

13. Do we have a _____ pencil in the desk?

14. He shifted the bike into a lower _____.

15. The dog was big, brown, and _____.

16. Let's _____ the two answers and see which is right.

17. The _____ clock rang at seven this morning.

18. The winter wind felt _____ on our faces.

19. Please take the clean laundry _____.

20. We sat on a bench in the town _____.

21. Be _____ of the icy steps by the door.

22. _____ me, I did not hear what you said.

23. She wants a _____ as a veterinarian.

24. After the long hike, we were tired and _____.

Spelling Detective

Name: _____ Date: _____

Each sentence has ONE misspelled word. Circle it. Write it the right way.
Then write the letter of the clue that explains the mistake.

Clues

A. /är/ like star is spelled ar.
B. /âr/ at the end of a word is usually spelled are.
C. /âr/ in the middle of a word or before y is usually spelled air.
D. /îr/ like ear is often spelled ear.
E. /îr/ at the end of a word can be spelled eer.
F. This word is a rule-breaker: /îr/ is spelled eir.
G. Scarce is like scare, plus a c. The last c says /s/.
H. Earring is ear + ring. Don't forget both r's.

1. Be careful, that knife is shairp.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

2. Loud thunder can scair the dog.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

3. Dad will repare the broken chair.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

4. A teer rolled down her cheek when the movie ended.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

5. The fans began to chear for the team.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

6. The soup had a wierd green color.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

7. Shade was scarse on the hot playground.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

8. Mom found a silver earing under the couch.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

Look, Say, Cover, Write, Check (1 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Look at the word and say it. Cover it and write it. Uncover it and check. ✓ = right!

Look & Say	Write & Check	Write & Check	Write & Check
spark	☐	☐	☐
prepare	☐	☐	☐
cheer	☐	☐	☐
tear	☐	☐	☐
scarf	☐	☐	☐
scare	☐	☐	☐
repair	☐	☐	☐
earring	☐	☐	☐
scarce	☐	☐	☐
weird	☐	☐	☐
sharp	☐	☐	☐
rear	☐	☐	☐

Look, Say, Cover, Write, Check (2 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Look at the word and say it. Cover it and write it. Uncover it and check. ✓ = right!

Look & Say	Write & Check	Write & Check	Write & Check
spare	☐	☐	☐
gear	☐	☐	☐
hairy	☐	☐	☐
compare	☐	☐	☐
alarm	☐	☐	☐
harsh	☐	☐	☐
upstairs	☐	☐	☐
square	☐	☐	☐
aware ★	☐	☐	☐
pardon ★	☐	☐	☐
career ★	☐	☐	☐
weary ★	☐	☐	☐

ABC Order

Name: _____ Date: _____

Put each group in ABC order. Same first letter? Look at the next letter!

Group 1

Same first letter? Look closer!

scare scarf scarce
spark sharp spare

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Group 2

Look at the 2nd letter!

alarm aware cheer
compare career earring

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Group 3

p, r, and t words

prepare pardon repair
rear tear upstairs

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Group 4

g, h, w, and more

gear hairy harsh
weird weary square

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Practice Spelling Test

Name: _____ Date: _____

Listen to the word and the sentence. Write the word on the line.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____
21. _____
22. _____
23. _____
24. _____

For Grown-Ups: Answer Key & Read-Aloud List

Word Sort (by sound)

/är/ (like car & star): spark (ar), scarf (ar), sharp (ar), alarm (ar), harsh (ar), pardon (ar)
/âr/ (like care & hair): prepare (are), scare (are), scarce (are), spare (are), compare (are), square (are), aware (are), repair (air), hairy (air), upstairs (air)
/îr/ (like ear & deer): tear (ear), earring (ear), rear (ear), gear (ear), weary (ear), cheer (eer), career (eer), weird (eir)

Note: tear goes with /îr/ (a drop from your eye). The other meaning, to rip paper, says /âr/ like care.

are, air, or ear? ear, eer, or eir?

1. eer (cheer)
2. are (scare)
3. ear (tear)
4. are (prepare)
5. ear (gear)
6. air (repair)
7. eir (weird)
8. are (spare)
9. ear (rear)
10. air (hairy)
11. are (compare)
12. ear (earring)
13. are (square)
14. air (upstairs)
15. are (aware)
16. eer (career)
17. ear (weary)

Fill in the Blank

1. spark
2. prepare
3. cheer
4. tear
5. scarf
6. scare
7. repair
8. earring
9. scarce
10. weird
11. sharp
12. rear
13. spare
14. gear
15. hairy
16. compare
17. alarm
18. harsh
19. upstairs
20. square
21. aware
22. pardon
23. career
24. weary

Spelling Detective

1. shairp → sharp (clue A)
2. scair → scare (clue B)
3. repare → repair (clue C)
4. teer → tear (clue D)
5. chear → cheer (clue E)
6. wierd → weird (clue F)
7. scarse → scarce (clue G)
8. earing → earring (clue H)

ABC Order

Group 1: scarce, scare, scarf, sharp, spare, spark
Group 2: alarm, aware, career, cheer, compare, earring
Group 3: pardon, prepare, rear, repair, tear, upstairs
Group 4: gear, hairy, harsh, square, weary, weird

Practice Test: say the word, read the sentence, then say the word again.

1. cheer The fans began to cheer for the team.
2. spark A spark jumped from the campfire.
3. scare Loud thunder can scare the dog.
4. tear A tear rolled down her cheek when the movie ..
5. sharp Be careful, that knife is sharp.
6. prepare We need to prepare a snack for the hike.
7. gear He shifted the bike into a lower gear.
8. scarf She wrapped a red scarf around her neck.
9. repair Dad will repair the broken chair.
10. weird The soup had a weird green color.
11. alarm The alarm clock rang at seven.
12. spare Do we have a spare pencil?
13. rear The rear door of the van was open.
14. hairy The dog was big and hairy.
15. harsh The wind felt harsh on our faces.
16. compare Let's compare the two answers.
17. earring Mom found a silver earring under the couch.
18. square We sat on a bench in the town square.
19. scarce Shade was scarce on the hot playground.
20. upstairs Please take the laundry upstairs.
21. aware Be aware of the icy steps.
22. pardon Pardon me, I did not hear you.
23. career She wants a career as a veterinarian.
24. weary After the long hike, we were weary.